NARENDRA MODI

25 YEARS OF REFORMS

As Narendra Modi completes 25 years as head of governments—first as chief minister of Gujarat from 2001 onward, and then as prime minister from 2014—a look at 25 landmark reforms and schemes initiated under his leadership

Compiled by **M.G. ARUN**

1 PORT REVOLUTION*

Private capital was invited in 2001 to build ports in Gujarat. Mundra, Hazira and Pipavav emerged as major private ports

Impact: By 2014, Gujarat handled around 39% of India's total cargo

2 WATER REFORMS*

*Launched the **Sujalam Sufalam Jal Abhiyan** in 2003 to harness surplus Narmada floodwaters that benefited 10 water-scarce and drought-prone districts in Saurashtra, Kutch and North Gujarat*

Impact: By 2012, Gujarat had built over 150,000 check dams, helping irrigate over 1 mn hectares

3 SOLAR THRUST

*Launched the **National Solar Mission** in 2014*

Impact: India's solar capacity rose from 2.8 GW in 2014 to nearly 165 GW by July 2026. **PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana**, launched in 2024, crossed 5.1 mn households by Aug. 2026

4 BANKING REFORMS

Launched in 2014, honest classification of stress, recapitalisation, mergers and tighter provisioning strengthened PSU banks

Impact: Gross NPAs fell from about 11.2% in March 2018 to 1.8% in March 2026

5 FINANCIAL INCLUSION

*In 2014, **PM Jan Dhan Yojana** put bank accounts at the centre of JAM trinity—Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile—enabling **direct benefit transfer (DBT)***

Impact: By Aug. 2026, 590 mn accounts had been opened, with Rs 3.15 lakh crore in deposits

6 DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER

Designed in 2014 to send welfare payments directly to beneficiary accounts

Impact: More than Rs 53 lakh crore has moved through **DBT** across 320 schemes, with savings of over Rs 5 lakh crore from leakage



7 CLEAN INDIA DRIVE

***Swachh Bharat Mission**, launched in 2014, facilitated construction of over 120 mn household toilets and enabled villages to be declared Open Defecation Free by 2019*

Impact: A 2024 study linked higher toilet coverage with significantly lower infant/ under-five mortality

**Initiated as Gujarat CM*